



NAVIGATING THE DIRE STRAITS

(From left) **Vibha Padalkar**, MD & CEO, HDFC Life Insurance
Sanjiv Mehta, Executive Chairman, L Catterton
Amish Mehta, MD & CEO, Crisil
Shanti Ekambaram, Former Deputy MD, Kotak Mahindra Bank
Sanjeev Krishan, Chairperson, PwC in India

» Padalkar framed the disruption as a catalyst for innovation. "Never waste a good crisis," she said, pointing to lessons from the pandemic

» While acknowledging that "the era of Great Moderation is over," Sanjiv stressed that India's macroeconomic fundamentals, including strong forex reserves and growth rates, remain intact

» "The buffers that we have are in

a good place," Amish said, citing a stable fiscal position, a manageable current account deficit, and healthier corporate balance sheets

» Ekambaram underlined the strength of both macroeconomic and corporate fundamentals heading into the crisis

» "What used to happen once in 10 years is now happening once in 10 months," Krishan observed, referring to economic shocks

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FUELS OF GROWTH

(From left) **Ashish Kumar**, MD, VERBIO India; **G. Krishnakumar**, Former Chairman and MD, BPCL; **Atul Mulay**, President—Bioenergy, Praj Industries; **Arnab Basu**, Chief Industries Officer, PwC India

» Kumar highlighted that while the country has vast agricultural resources and significant organic waste potential, the transition towards alternative fuels has been delayed and cannot be achieved overnight

» Basu emphasised India's vulnerability owing to rising crude prices, however, adding that Indian agriculture's exposure to the oil shocks is something that hasn't been

talked about

» Krishnakumar said BPCL was short of 25-30 cargoes at the time of the event, and that managing LPG usage with other sources has become a critical task

» Mulay of Praj Industries said that an energy crisis has given a new normal in energy—green crude, and the importance of setting up biorefineries

